

Idea Scoring Sheet

Narrow to 1–2 *ideas* deliberately, against a shared yardstick — not by defaulting to whichever one you're most attached to. Score first, then hear feedback, then choose.

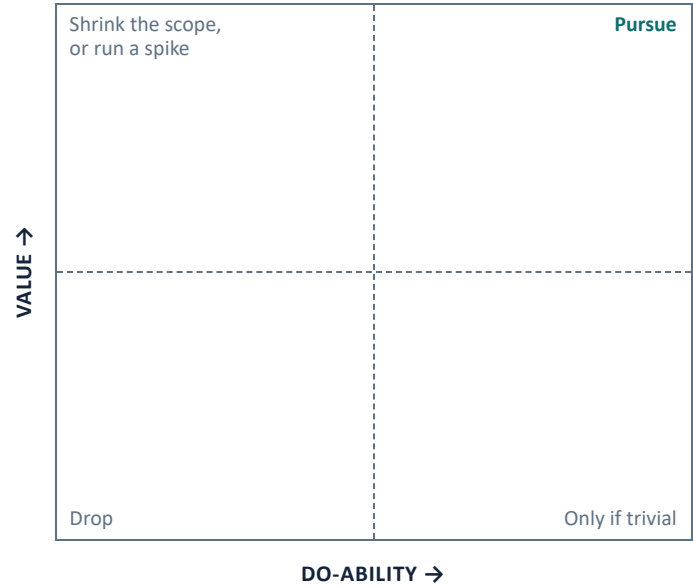
Name _____

1 • Score each candidate — 1 (weak) · 2 · 3 (strong)

CRITERION	WHAT A "3" LOOKS LIKE	IDEA A	IDEA B	IDEA C
	<i>name each idea →</i>	_____	_____	_____
Real need, reachable users	A specific userbase with a felt, evidenced need			
Richness / breadth	Exercises multiple engineering dimensions			
One-semester MVP	A coherent vertical slice fits the real build window — roughly five weeks, out of a ~10 hrs/week that also covers class, reading, writing, and reviews			
Feasibility	Risks named and reducible (see the risk worksheet)			
Extensible / room to grow	Others could join and keep building			
Open-source-worthy	Appropriate to build and release in the open			
Tractable stack	Tech you can own, explain, and support			
Total	Higher = stronger — but a fatal flaw on real need or feasibility outweighs a high total			

The two students most often miss: *real need* and *richness*. An idea that's easy and fun to build but serves no one, or is too thin to grow, scores low here on purpose. **These criteria are ours, on purpose** — chosen for founding a lasting, open-source project. What transfers is the method: score against explicit criteria, weigh value against do-ability, get feedback, commit.

2 • Plot on Value vs. Do-ability — mark A, B, and C where they land



- **High value + high do-ability** → your best candidates. **Pursue.**
 - **High value + low do-ability** → worth it *if* you can shrink the scope or run a spike to raise do-ability. Note how.
 - **Low value** → drop, however easy. Easy-but-pointless is still pointless.
- Where each landed — and its biggest risk (*pull the risk from your Feasibility & Risk Worksheet*)
- A • quadrant _____ risk _____
- B • quadrant _____ risk _____
- C • quadrant _____ risk _____

3 • Peer feedback — *capture, don't defend*

Small groups of 3–4, round-robin, about four minutes each. Everyone presents once.

Present ~90 sec

Your top 1–2 ideas: the user, the real need, why it scored well. If it's high-value but low-do-ability, say how you'd shrink it.

Pressure-test ~2.5 min

The group challenges it: is the need real and the user reachable? feasible at one-semester scope? rich enough to found on?

Each response

Affirm what's strong → name the sharpest concern → one concrete suggestion.

Is the need real, and the user reachable?

Feasible at one-semester scope?

Rich enough to found on?

The one change that would most strengthen it

Write down what you hear. Don't argue, don't explain — you'll weigh it in Part 4. Defending in the moment is how feedback gets wasted.

4 • Converge — *pick 1–2, and write the rationale*

Weigh the scores and the feedback. A working direction, not an irreversible vow — but your discovery and proposal work focus here from now on.

Chosen idea

Rationale — **it's for** (who), **who need** (the real need); **feasible because** (scope / risk read); **rich because** (dimensions it touches)

Second idea, if you're carrying two — and its rationale
